

know Gayatri more, as in how she is. As a pair, we needed to share those moments. I am so grateful that, as a friend, off court also, she is so supportive. She is there if I need any help.

You won your first big tournament on the BWF World Tour circuit at the Syed Modi International in Lucknow last year.

Gayatri: It was the first time someone (Indian women's pair) had won. I didn't know that until we won the tournament. It's a great feeling to win in the country. After winning the tournament, both of us were in tears.

Treesa: We always dreamt of winning such tournaments. Being on the podium and receiving that gold medal is a different feeling. The fans were calling us with different names. It was like a dream. It's happiness that can't be described.

You narrowly missed out on Paris, but time is on your side. What did you take away from your first Olympic cycle?

Gayatri: We missed out on the Paris Olympics, but that's not the end. The LA Olympics 2028 is coming up. We didn't lose heart. We kept training hard, just looking for opportunities

in the next tournament. The Olympics is not the only important tournament. There are a lot more important events. It was heartbreaking to lose out on making it to the Olympics, but I feel more opportunities are coming our way.

Treesa: Like she said, we missed out on the Olympics, but we did train continuously. It was a little hard to believe that we didn't qualify. But after that, the calendar was packed, and we started to play and perform from the next tournament.

And at the end of the year, we won the Syed Modi International. It's

the 'never give up' attitude.

You mentioned that the calendar is packed. Does that make it tough to rest and recover?

Treesa: We need to accept that the calendar is hard. We need to be very choosy about the tournaments we play. During the tournaments, we need to focus on our physical health and condition, and how we play and recover. It is not only for us. It is the same for everyone. That's the reality we need to accept.

(To Treesa) How did you sustain your shoulder injury?

Treesa: The day after the All England Open pre-quarterfinals, it was hurting, and it was hard to play. Still, we continued to play the Swiss Open. We reached the semifinals, but it was getting hard for me to smash.

The physio said that I needed a break. We didn't take a break from January to March. We played continuous tournaments. That's why both of us decided to withdraw from the Asia Championships since it would be better for our health.

Gayatri: We just have to support each other because in doubles, it happens. Your partner is not fit

